

Classroom Environment Checklist 2025-2026

Middle School Grades 6-8

Classroom Expectations	Completed (Y or N) Additional Comments
<u>Classroom Doors</u> • Welcoming classroom doors with teacher names • Glass must be kept clear (chart paper will be provided for drills) • Remember that all classroom doors must be closed and locked if your room is not in use. • Classroom Schedule & Teacher/Class Name posted (will be provided by Admin)	
<u>Sign Out Clipboard</u> Bathroom/Water/Nurse/Main Office/Provider Sheet (available in the main office) <i>Students who are physically leaving the classroom must sign out every time they leave. If a provider picks them up from the classroom they must sign them out.</i>	
<u>Posted on Whiteboard (front of the room)</u> • Current Date • Learning Target (<i>I will be able to / IWBAT...</i>) • Lesson Agenda - An overview of the flow of the lesson for that period. The agenda shows the lesson chunks and the approximate times. <u>Example of Lesson Agenda:</u> Do Now (5 min) Video (10 min) Discussion (10 min) Independent Work (12 min)	
<u>Unit of Study Area</u> <i>Designated area on classroom wall/bulletin board to post information displaying the current unit of study for each class/grade level</i> • Current Unit of Study • Essential or Focusing Questions • End of Unit Task	
<u>Classroom Agreements / Charter</u> Collaboratively created classroom agreements that are positively phrased and posted (e.g. We stay focused and try our best, We treat each other with respect, etc.)	

<u>Lesson Plans</u> Lesson plan must be easily accessible to administration. It is best as a hard copy, but if it is a soft copy, then you will be asked to send it to administration electronically by 2:25pm. Click here for links to lesson plan templates.	
<u>Vocabulary Areas</u> • Unit/Academic Vocabulary - This section should contain vocabulary words that are relevant to your current unit of study. This section will change with your units. Include pictures and definitions with each word (i.e. - hieroglyphics, fertile crescent, equator).	
<u>Clean Classrooms</u> • No clutter (e.g. empty boxes, random papers, broken computers) • Windowsills cleared off (e.g. no loose papers) • Shelving units are kept tidy • Anchor Charts are visible to students and current • Posters are not torn, wrinkled, or old • Counters and tables are kept clean and organized (e.g. no pencil shavings, dust, student belongings, etc.) • Student desks are kept clean and empty • Teacher desk is organized and clean	
<u>Signage</u> All areas of the classroom must be clearly labeled (e.g.. classroom library, portfolios, bulletin boards, notebooks, bins, binders). When possible signs should be electronically printed. If they are handwritten, they must be legible, attractive and neat.	
<u>Instructional Charts/Anchor Charts</u> Instructional charts are vital for displaying what you have been teaching. Students use these as a resource, and they bring the units alive in your classroom. All charts should be current and relevant, hanging straight, and not torn or crumpled. <i>*See bottom of checklist for examples*</i>	
<u>Portfolio Assessment Folders</u> Designated folder which includes: • Table of Contents for Performance Tasks (indicates if piece is digital or on paper) • Table of Contents for Unit Assessment (e.g. tests, quizzes)	

All items in this folder must include rubrics and feedback.	
<u>Bulletin Boards (Classroom and Hallway)</u> <i>All backing paper must be replaced for the 2024-2025 school year.</i> Designated sections for each content area, clearly labeled, with authentic student work of varying levels (at least 10 student samples) and meaningful feedback based on a rubric. Feedback should include a specific next step and a strategy for getting there, as well as one area of celebration, both based on the rubric. Bulletin Boards should include: Teacher name(s), Date, Standards addressed, Task, Rubric, Student work with feedback.	
<u>Classroom Library/Resource Center (labeled as such)</u> All bins/books should be easily accessible to students, and bins should be maintained and kept tidy. All ELA/ENL rooms must have a clearly labeled library with books organized by genre. All other contents should have content specific libraries/resource centers.	
<u>Safety</u> • Visible and accessible Red Emergency Folder (includes Assembly Cards) and updated student rosters • Allergy notification system (ie. Nut Free Zone sign provided by Admin) as needed	
<u>Additional Classroom Expectations:</u> • <i>Food and Drinks:</i> No glass bottles are permitted in the school building. If you permit students to eat in the classroom, ensure that all trash is properly removed. • <i>Outer Clothing:</i> Make sure students have removed their hoods, caps, hats and jackets when they are in your room. If students are cold, they are permitted to wear long sleeves under their uniform shirts. • <i>School Bags:</i> Make sure that all school bags have been removed and placed on the back of students' chairs. • <i>Sports Equipment:</i> Sports equipment is not allowed to be visible in the classroom or hallways during instructional time. If sports equipment becomes a distraction to teaching and learning it must be taken from the student.	

- *Cell Phones:* Phones are collected in the morning and returned at the end of the school day. They are not allowed in the classroom.

SMART/Promethean Boards

All boards need to be turned off, and equipment stored properly when not in use. Please do not tape items to the touch screen portion of the board.

SAMPLE ANCHOR CHARTS:

Put the CHART TITLE UP HERE!

Connect to prior lessons; post a target or objective.

This is where you want to TEACH!

- Include the key information you want students to know.
- Be clear and concise.
- Represent with simple images if you can.
- Organize smaller chunks...

Like This... | And This... | And This.

Down HERE is your chance to MODEL.

Give reminders of your thought processes here.

Give tips or cues to help students apply.

Create a "mock" notebook, or whatever it is that students use to respond. Underline a few important stems, or sentence starters.

Dividing Whole # By Fractions ^{6.NS.1}

Sarah bought 4 bags of candy corn for Halloween baskets. She is making 2 baskets. She wants to put $\frac{1}{2}$ a bag of candy corn in each basket. How many baskets can she make?

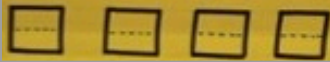
Step 1: Ask yourself "What equation will help me to solve this division problem?"

Do → Identify the dividend and divisor.

$$\frac{4}{\text{Dividend}} \div \frac{1}{2} \text{ Divisor} = ? \text{ Quotient}$$

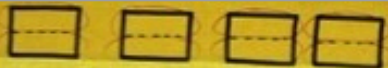
Step 2: Ask yourself "How do I represent my dividend as a visual fraction model?"

Do → Draw the dividend using a fraction model and divide each whole into equal parts based on the denominator.



Step 3: Ask yourself "How do I represent my divisor, or each group, within my visual fraction model?"

Do → Show the groupings by circling the amount of parts as shown in the numerator of the divisor.



Step 4: Ask yourself "How many total groups were made? Are there any fractional pieces remaining?"

Do → Count the total number of groups. If there are pieces remaining, create a mixed number with the remaining pieces as the numerator and the total number of parts that make up one group as the denominator.

